

Q I am going to purchase a PC in the first week of August. This PC will be used for gaming and video editing, although I may do some programming. My budget is around Rs 55,000. Should I opt for a dual core or a quad core? 2 GB or 4 GB of RAM? Please suggest a good 22-inch monitor as well. Also, suggest a good cabinet and power supply. What is the difference in performance between DDR2 800 MHz and DDR2 1066 MHz? How much would a good UPS cost me?

Samir Ranjan Ray



My recommendation is as follows:

PC Config		
Component	Recommendation	Price
Processor	Core 2 Duo E8400	Rs 8,400
Motherboard	Abit IP35-E	Rs 5,200
RAM	4x1 GB DDR2 800 MHz (Transcend)	Rs 4,200
Graphics Card	GeForce 8800GT (Gigabyte)	Rs 10,800
HDD	Western Digital WD 5000 AAKS	Rs 4,200
Monitor	Dell E2208WFP	Rs 15,500
Cabinet	Cooler Master CM 690	Rs 4,000
Power Supply	Corsair HX520W	Rs 5,300
	Total	Rs 57,600

In case the budget of Rs 55,000 is not flexible, I suggest you opt for a slightly cheaper processor (Core 2 Duo E6750), or even look at 2 GB of RAM in lieu of 4 GB. This will get the job done, but if you can splurge a bit more to purchase exactly what I've suggested, I'm sure you won't be disappointed.

As for your other queries, DDR2 800 MHz memory is not more than 8 per cent slower than DDR2 1066 MHz memory. It is possible to run faster (1066 MHz) RAM at tighter (faster) timings, in which case 1066 MHz DDR2 RAM can even be run at 800 MHz, where it can outperform DDR2 800 MHz memory that runs at looser timings. For a UPS, look at brands like APC and Numeric. I've personally used an 800 VA Numeric UPS for more than three years without any problems.

Q I want to buy a 2 GB DDR2 RAM for my Compaq Presario v3402tx laptop. The RAM details are somewhat like this—PC2-5300 DDR2 SODIMM slot. Please tell me the pricing of 1 GB, 2 GB and both frequencies (667 MHz and 800 MHz).

Abhishek Patel



Look for Kingston or Transcend memory. DDR2 667 MHz will suffice and you needn't look at 800 MHz memory. 2 GB of notebook memory should cost you around Rs 2,600 (DDR2 667) and Rs 3,200 (DDR2 800).

Q I have an AMD Athlon 3000+, MSI RS480 motherboard, 512 DDR1 RAM with 160 HDD. I love playing PC games, so now I'm confused about whether I should upgrade my PC or go with a graphic card, to avoid the upgrade. Please suggest a solution.

Jaidev Jindal



Ask Away!

Want a tech product, but don't know how to go about buying it? E-mail agent001@thinkdigit.com with your complete contact details, and he might answer them here! Please note that Agent001 only answers purchase-related questions in this space.



If you want serious eye-candy, forget about your current PC. I'd recommend a processor, motherboard, RAM, and graphics card upgrade. Along with this, you may need to upgrade your SMPS as well. For the motherboard, look at the Abit IP35-E that I've suggested for question 1. Opt for 2 GB of DDR2 800 MHz memory, with either an E6750 or E8400 Core 2 Duo processor. If you want to enjoy games at low to medium resolutions, then look at the NVIDIA GeForce 8600GT chipset-based solutions for around Rs 4,500. For a slightly better gaming experience, the GeForce 9600GT chipset (Rs 8,000) is a good option. The GeForce 8800GT (Rs 11,000) offers the best bang for buck. For the power supply, look at Cooler Masters 650 Watt extreme PSU, which will cost Rs 3,500.

Q I am a Technical Analyst in an IT company. The software I run needs at least 2 GB of RAM. So I need a laptop with considerable processing and 2 GB of RAM at least. I would prefer a good graphics solution, so that I can play games occasionally. I could use a few video connectivity options for viewing movies. I do not have any preference for screen size. My budget is upto Rs 55,000. Anything easily available and serviceable in Kolkata would be a plus.

Sagnik Banerjee



I have two recommendations. One is HP's DV2701 Special Edition, tested in our June issue. At 14.1 inches, it's compact and great to look at. Powered by a Core 2 Duo and a GeForce 8400GS, you also get an HDMI port for large screen connectivity. Another recommendation with a more powerful configuration would be the Dell XPS 1530, which has a better processor and graphics card, but a larger 15.4-inch screen. Both are available with 160 GB HDDs.

Q I want to buy a PMP which can read e-books too. Please suggest if it is wise to buy a gadget with both capabilities, or should I buy two specialised devices? I read about the Cowon D2 in *Digit* and my brother-in-law checked this out, but he didn't like the sound quality. Now I'm confused, so please help me out. My budget is under Rs 12,000.

Sapna



Did he check the sound quality of the Cowon D2 on the default earplugs? Or possibly was the piece damaged in some way? The D2 is one of the best sounding PMPs around and it's impossible not to like its sound quality. Do try to use the D2 with a decent set of earplugs like Creative's EP630 (Rs 800), which will allow the D2 to show its stuff off. I can assure you the award for the best PMP in its category wasn't awarded lightly, and you can go ahead and buy it. It's a very feature-rich device that will be a superb e-book reader. ☐